

— SELL-SIDE M&A

The Madfarm Process

Five phases, three decision gates, and roughly thirty-three weeks from kickoff to close. Preparation runs the same way on every engagement. Market strategy is built for yours alone.

— HOW WE WORK

Structurally rigorous. Strategically flexible.

Two halves of one process — and they are not interchangeable.

— STRUCTURALLY RIGOROUS

Preparation is fixed

- The same discipline on every engagement, in the same order
- Every obstacle surfaced, contextualized and mitigated before market
- A file a buyer can underwrite from on the day they receive it
- No post-LOI diligence delays

— STRATEGICALLY FLEXIBLE

Market strategy is built

- Buyer mix, sequencing and process type are set to your goals
- Strategy is derived from what preparation reveals about the business
- Adapts to market realities rather than applying a fixed playbook
- Designed once, then executed with discipline

We control the process calendar. Buyers react to our pace rather than setting it — that is where leverage in a sell-side process actually comes from.

— THE ARC

Five phases, thirty-three weeks.

Typical ranges for an engagement of this profile, measured from kickoff.



— DECISION POINTS

Three gates control the process.

Nothing crosses a gate until the work behind it is complete and you have signed off.

01

Launch approval

Week 10

- Final financial workbook
- Deal-ready data room
- Approved CIM and blind teaser
- Approved buyer list
- Agreed go-to-market strategy

YOU DECIDE

02

LOI selection

Week 20

- Competing offers received
- Evaluated on price, structure, certainty of close and fit
- Counterparty diligence complete
- Exclusivity terms negotiated

**YOU DECIDE, ON OUR
RECOMMENDATION**

03

Close

Week 33

- Confirmatory diligence complete
- Definitive agreements executed
- Net working capital settled
- Funds flow confirmed

**JOINT — WITH YOUR
COUNSEL**

Between gates we move without asking. At each gate we stop, and the decision is yours.

— PHASE BY PHASE

What actually happens, and when.

01

Evaluation

Pre-engagement ·
complimentary

A discovery session and a preliminary valuation, at no cost and before any paid engagement begins.

02

Foundation

Weeks 0–3

Goals and process meetings, data room build, and financial and operations discovery — the single biggest driver of your launch date.

03

Preparation

Weeks 2–10

Financial preparation, quality of earnings, market analysis and go-to-market design. Quality of earnings is the long pole — it sets the launch date.

04

Market

Weeks 11–20

Tiered outreach, NDAs and CIM release, management meetings, then IOIs and LOI selection. We name the buyer list in week nine, from evidence.

05

Close

Weeks 21–33

Confirmatory diligence, definitive agreement, net working capital true-up, funds flow and close. Diligence confirms known facts rather than discovering new ones.

— WHAT YOU RECEIVE

Six deliverables, all yours.

Produced during preparation, used through close, and yours to keep afterward.

01

Financial workbook

Normalized P&L, adjusted EBITDA, cash flow, customer analysis and net working capital — the underwriting file.

02

Deal-ready data room

Structured, populated, access-controlled and organized the way a buyer's diligence team works.

03

Confidential information memorandum

The full narrative and financial case for the business, released only under NDA.

04

Blind teaser

An anonymized one-page profile used for every first approach.

05

Buyer list

Named, tiered and researched — built from market evidence, not a database pull.

06

Go-to-market strategy

Buyer mix, sequencing, pacing, process type and the outreach plan.

— CONFIDENTIALITY

Your business never appears on a marketplace.

Confidentiality is a process design decision, not a disclaimer at the bottom of a page.

01

Direct to decision maker

Every approach is made by us, to a named decision maker at a researched buyer. No intermediaries and no brokers' networks.

02

Blinded until NDA

Buyers see an anonymized teaser. Nothing that identifies your business is released until an NDA is executed.

03

No public posting

Never listed on a marketplace, platform or listing site. There is no public record that it is for sale.

04

All exchange through the data room

Access is granted deliberately, tracked, and revocable at any time.

05

Employee engagement is deal-specific

Who gets read in, and when, is your decision — planned with you rather than defaulted.

— YOUR COMMITMENTS

What we need from you.

The timeline holds when these are met. It is the one part of the process we do not control.

01	Foundation Weeks 0–3	Document request returned in full. Two discovery working sessions, roughly half a day each. Data room access and initial population.
02	Preparation Weeks 2–10	Quality of earnings requests answered as they arrive. Two review cycles on the financial workbook. Approval of the CIM, teaser, buyer list and strategy.
03	Market Weeks 11–20	Availability for management meetings, typically three to six. Site visit access where requested. Timely decisions on IOIs and LOIs.
04	Close Weeks 21–33	Confirmatory diligence responses through the data room. M&A counsel engaged and available. Final working capital and funds flow sign-off.

We will tell you what is needed and when. **You will never learn about a deliverable on the day it is due.**

— HOW WE RUN IT

Cadence and communication.

Weekly standing call

Thirty minutes. Status against the timeline, decisions needed from you, and what is coming next.

Written update

Delivered before each call — workstream status, blockers, and your upcoming deliverables.

Direct escalation

Anything urgent comes straight to the principal. There is no account team to route through.

— START WITH EVALUATION

We control the timeline. Control is leverage.

Our complimentary pre-engagement process — a discovery session and a preliminary valuation — comes before any paid engagement. No cost, no obligation.

info@madfarm-advisors.com · madfarm-advisors.com